Kitchen *& Kettle*

Homesteader's Almanac

A RECORD OF A PLACE, KEPT OVER TIME.

A fill-in-your-own almanac for the dates, weather, animals, harvests, failures, fixes, and small observations that become a household's history.

Write in it once a week or once a season.

How to keep this almanac

This is a place to notice what happened here. It does not need to be complete, polished, or written on schedule.

START WITH THE YEAR

On the opening page, write down the dates and conditions you already know. First frost. Last frost. When the swallows returned. When the first tomato ripened. The week the well pump failed. The winter the hens stopped laying.

COME BACK WHEN YOU HAVE SOMETHING TO SAY

Use the seasonal pages for a few lines at a time. A storm that changed the garden. A repair that held. A variety worth planting again. A flock behaving strangely. A week when everything came in at once.

LET THE RECORD BE ORDINARY

Ten years from now, the small things will be the useful things. What froze. What sprouted early. What you stopped buying. What worked better than expected. What you will never do that way again.

KEEP IT YOURS

Write in shorthand, draw a map, tape in a seed packet, or leave a page blank. This is not a performance of a good homestead. It is a record of the place you actually live.

> *Type directly into the fields and your entries save automatically in this browser. Or print blank pages and write by hand. Use “Save a copy” before moving to a new device.*

The year at a glance

> *Use one page for each year. Add a fresh copy of the seasonal pages when you want more room.*

YEAR

PLACE

ELEVATION / REGION

WEATHER AND SKY

LAST FROST

FIRST FROST

FIRST SNOW

LONGEST DRY SPELL

BIGGEST STORM

RAINIEST MONTH

SIGNS OF THE YEAR

WHEN THE SWALLOWS RETURNED

FIRST FROG / CRICKET / FIREFLY

FIRST TOMATO, BEAN, OR BERRY

LAST THING HARVESTED

FIRST EGGS / FIRST CHICK / FIRST LAMB

ONE THING THAT SURPRISED ME

THE SHAPE OF THIS YEAR

Sun and moon notes

Use this page to notice the light you live by. Record what you see and what was happening here at the same time.

SUN

SPRING EQUINOX

SUMMER SOLSTICE

AUTUMN EQUINOX

WINTER SOLSTICE

LONGEST DAY / SHORTEST DAY

FIRST LIGHT OR LAST LIGHT WORTH REMEMBERING

MOON

NEW MOON DATES

FULL MOON DATES

BRIGHTEST MOONLIT NIGHT

MOONRISE OR MOONSET WORTH REMEMBERING

A NIGHT THE SKY CHANGED THE WORK

WHAT I NOTICED

WHAT WAS HAPPENING UNDER THAT SKY?

When the ground opens

Record the first signs, the false starts, and what you were glad to have ready.

FIRST PLANTING

FIRST BLOOM

LAST HARD FREEZE

WHAT HAPPENED

WHAT WORKED

WHAT I WOULD CHANGE

SMALL THINGS WORTH KEEPING

SEASON NOTES

When everything comes at once

> *Harvests overlap. Weather makes its own decisions. Write down what you want to remember before the season moves on.*

FIRST RIPE TOMATO

FIRST FULL HARVEST

HOTTEST STRETCH

WHAT HAPPENED

WHAT WORKED

WHAT I WOULD CHANGE

SMALL THINGS WORTH KEEPING

SEASON NOTES

When the work comes home

> *This is the season of gathering, preserving, putting away, and noticing what the year gave you.*

FIRST FROST

LAST GARDEN HARVEST

FIRST WOOD FIRE

WHAT HAPPENED

WHAT WORKED

WHAT I WOULD CHANGE

SMALL THINGS WORTH KEEPING

SEASON NOTES

When the place gets quiet

> *Winter keeps its own record: what held, what failed, what rested, and what you learned to do differently.*

FIRST SNOW

COLDEST STRETCH

WHEN THE HENS SLOWED

WHAT HAPPENED

WHAT WORKED

WHAT I WOULD CHANGE

SMALL THINGS WORTH KEEPING

SEASON NOTES

The year in retrospect

09

Close the year with what you know now. These are the notes you will be grateful to find later.

KEEP

CHANGE

REMEMBER

NEXT YEAR BEGINS HERE

BEST MEAL

BEST HARVEST

BEST REPAIR

Ten years of this place

Use this index to mark the years you have kept. Add a short phrase for each one — the kind of note that helps you find the longer story later.

YEAR	THE WEATHER	THE WORK	WHAT I REMEMBER

THERE IS NO CORRECT PACE

Some years will fill quickly. Some will have only a few lines. A few true details are enough to make a record worth keeping.

NAMES OF THIS PLACE OVER TIME

Keep what happened here.

A life on a place is made of recurring things and one-time things: the same first frost, a different storm, a repair that finally held, a harvest you still talk about. Write down enough to recognize the shape of it later.

Works because it works.

Kitchen & Kettle

A quieter way to run a kitchen.